

Ryann Penrod

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EDUCATION

Brigham Young University

Provo, UT

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science, Human Computer Interaction Emphasis

Aug. 2023 – April 2028

- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Software Design, Human-Computer Interaction, Web Development, Database Systems

EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Dec 2025 – Present

BYU Family History Technology Lab

- * Engineered full-stack features for Relative Finder using Angular and Node.js, supporting a user base of 10,000+ monthly active users.
- * Partner with cross-functional teams including researchers and designers to integrate FamilySearch data, ensuring high-fidelity user experiences.
- * Streamline deployment cycles by conducting rigorous code reviews and automated testing.

For the Strength of Youth Conference Counselor

Summer 2026

- * Led and mentored youth groups during multi-day religious conferences across the United States.
- * Taught daily classes, facilitated group discussions, and provided individualized mentoring in English and Spanish.
- * Collaborated with counselor teams to organize activities, resolve conflicts, and create meaningful experiences for participants.
- * Demonstrated adaptability by working extended weeks in fast-paced, high-responsibility environments.

Full Time Missionary (Spanish Speaking)

Jul 2024 – Dec 2025

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints

- * Served as a Spanish-speaking missionary throughout the Las Vegas area.
- * Held leadership positions including Sister Training Leader, Missionary Trainer, and Social Media Office Representative.
- * Mentored and trained 20+ missionaries across 5+ companionships, coordinating weekly performance goals and operational logistics.
- * Communicated daily in Spanish while teaching, planning, and serving diverse communities.

PROJECTS

Relative Finder | *JavaScript, Python, Docker, PostgreSQL*

Oct 2023 – Present

- * Built a customizable ancestor collage feature that allows users to create personalized visual displays of family history.
- * Integrated FamilySearch API to automate data refresh, reducing manual sync latency by 40 and improving overall application responsiveness.
- * Conducted Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) studies, gathered user feedback, and iterated on designs to optimize user workflows.
- * Redesigned the UI to improve accessibility, resulting in a 15 increase in user retention for non-technical demographics.

ScriptShare | *JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS*

May 2026 – Present

- * Developing a full-stack scripture study application designed for users seeking meaningful study experiences during short periods of free time.
- * Conducted user research through surveys to identify study habits, preferences, and barriers to consistent scripture study.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C++, HTML/CSS,

Frameworks: React, Node.js

Developer Tools: Git, Docker, GitHub, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Gemini, Claude